include Johnson's map of the state of Jammu and Kashmir into the official Indian cartographic records. This then became one of the pillars of evidence for India's claim to Aksai Chin.

Pratap Singh Succeeds Ranbir Singh

Upon Maharaja Ranbir Singh's death in September 1885, his eldest son Pratap Singh became the new Maharaja. The full brunt of bearing the British insecurity generated during Ranbir Singh's rule now fell upon the new king. They appointed a Resident to monitor affairs in the state, overruling Pratap Singh's objections to this appointment. Though he improved the state's armed forces, Pratap Singh, like his father, continued to exclude ethnic Kashmiris from the army and the civil services. This calculated and sustained exclusion led to further alienation of the ethnic Muslim-Kashmiri people from their Dogra rulers.[15]

The years before the death of Ranbir Singh had caused a lot of turmoil within the Muslim population in the north-western parts of India and Afghanistan. After June 1878, the Congress of Berlin ended tensions between Britain and Russia; the latter, thereby, turned its sights on Central Asia. Russian envoys descended upon Kabul in July 1878, and the British unsuccessfully demanded the right to do the same from Sher Ali Khan, the Emir of Afghanistan. Despite the Emir refusing the British, they still sent a diplomatic mission to Kabul in September 1878, which was stopped at the border. This eventually triggered the Second Anglo-Afghan War and a British force of 50,000, consisting mostly of Indian troops, invaded Afghanistan.[16] Unable to enlist Czar Alexander's help, the Emir died in September 1879 at Mazar-i-Sharif.

The war finally ended in September 1880 with a British victory. The Second Anglo-Afghan War was, in many ways, a proxy war carried out by the British against the Russians. Consequently, any dalliance of any Indian ruler with the Russians was viewed as an act of treason by the British.

After the death of Maharaja Ranbir Singh in 1885, the British levelled charges of treason against his successor, Maharaja Pratap Singh. This